tion involving angry customers, unusual circumstances or judgment calls.

Davit Baghdasaryan, Co-founder and Chief Executive of Krisp, a voice AI major, says "AI agents are taking on work that is repeatable, rules-based and increasingly work that requires multiple steps." And the unit of work being delegated to agents is expanding. An engineering agent may start by suggesting code. Then it writes the code, tests it, debugs it and submits it for review. As the unit of work gets bigger, the human moves one level upward—from executor to director.

HR & HUMAN-AI RELATIONSHIP

The human takes over the complex interaction, as the machine begins feeding information to her. For instance in a bank, AI can collate transaction data, generate a report while the human sees what new products can be launched based on the report. This may become one of the defining human-AI relationships in the office: not replacement but escalation. Machines take the predictable path. Humans tread the unpredictable one.

So, if AI does the boring stuff, the worker needs more empathy and judgement, not merely the ability to follow a script. If AI writes elementary code, companies may need fewer people whose principal value is producing elementary code—but more engineers capable of evaluating architecture and identifying bad machine-generated solutions.

Padmashree Shagrithaya, Executive Vice President and Head of Insights & Data, India, Capgemini, says, "AI agents are rapidly evolving from task automators into autonomous collaborators. As enterprises adopt agentic systems at scale, we are moving from 'code-centric' development to 'specification-centric' development." Engineers increasingly need to tell agents precisely what business objective they are supposed to achieve, what constraints apply and how success should be measured.

Humans, therefore, move towards thinking about new systems, architecture, problem solving, validation and innovation, while agents provide speed and scale. If the machine writes the basic code, prepares the first analysis, and handles the easiest tasks, organisation structure will also change.

Baghdasaryan says, "AI will make organisations leaner and flatter. The long-term outcome is likely smaller teams, broader spans of responsibility and fewer layers between the people setting directions and AI agents executing it."



"AI agents now manage tasks such as first-level IT troubleshooting, software code generation, software testing, query resolution, telecom network monitoring, and so on"

NIKHIL MALHOTRA
CHIEF AI & INNOVATION OFFICER, TECH MAHINDRA



"There are three levels of maturity in AI agents. First is assistive. Second, you get into automation. Third is where it starts to get a little bit more intelligent in terms of supporting the decisions made"

JAIDEEP VIJAY DHOK
CHIEF OPERATING OFFICER—TECHNOLOGY, PERSISTENT SYSTEMS

CHALLENGES AHEAD

The main anxiety around AI agents remains job losses. Take, for example, mid-tier IT services company Coforge, which has collapsed its existing 13-layer architecture to just four bands. Earlier if it meant that employees went through learning cycles of applications development, software architecture, engineering and so on, it is now AI focused with AI-led engineering, data engineering, and cloud combined with domain knowledge.

In service providers like Mphasis, junior level engineering roles, typically referred to as L0 and L1